

Homework 3

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Set Up

```
# read in packages
library(tidyverse)
library(here)
library(janitor)
library(readxl)

# read in data
kelp <- read_csv(here("data", "temp-kelp.csv"))
walk <- read_csv(here("data", "ben-data-tracker.csv"))
```

Problem 1

a.

To determine the strength of the relationship between temperature (in Celsius) and kelp elongation rate (in cm per day), we will need a correlation test, of which there are two: Pearson's correlation (r) and Spearman's correlation (ρ). Both require independent observations. Pearson's correlation is the parametric version and also requires data that appears linear and continuous and that all variables are normally distributed. Spearman's correlation is the nonparametric version and requires data that is monotonic, meaning that as one variable increases, the other variable, on average, strictly increases or decreases; the trend cannot go up and down.

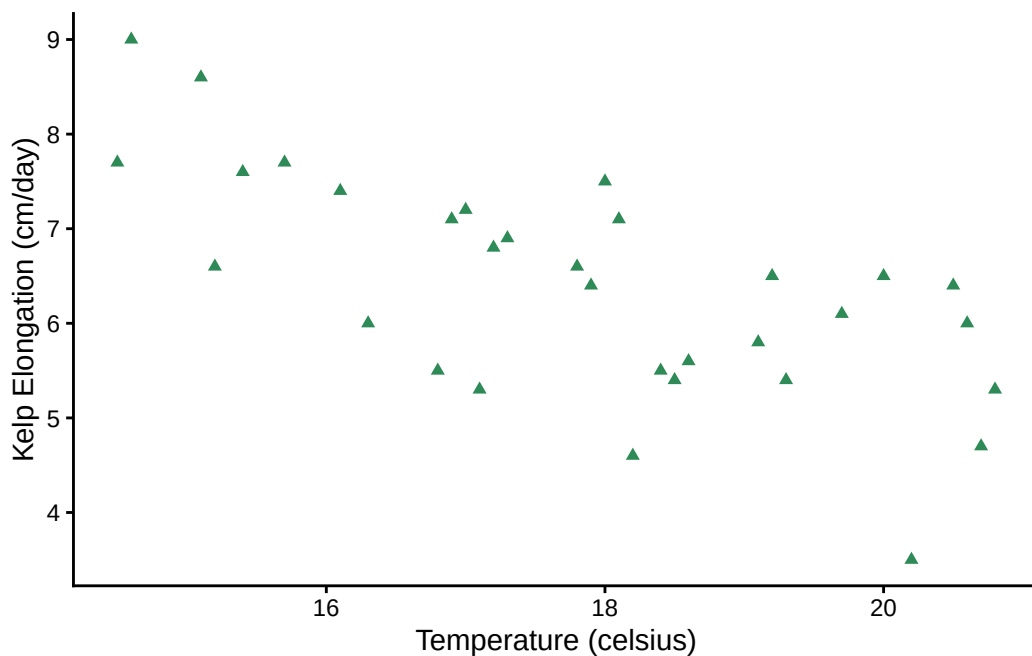
b.

```
# create base layer using kelp data
# predictor (x-axis): temperature
# response (y-axis): kelp_elong
ggplot(data = kelp,
       aes(
         x = temp_c,
         y = kelp_elong
       )) +
```

```

# add points, which creates a scatterplot for the data
geom_point(
  # change color to a kelp-like color
  color = "seagreen4",
  # change default shape
  shape = 17
) +
# change theme to remove gridlines
theme_classic() +
# rename x and y axes to make them more readable
labs(
  x = "Temperature (celsius)",
  y = "Kelp Elongation (cm/day)"
)

```



There may be a slight curve in the data, but a linear model also seems reasonable. We can check using diagnostic plots.

c.

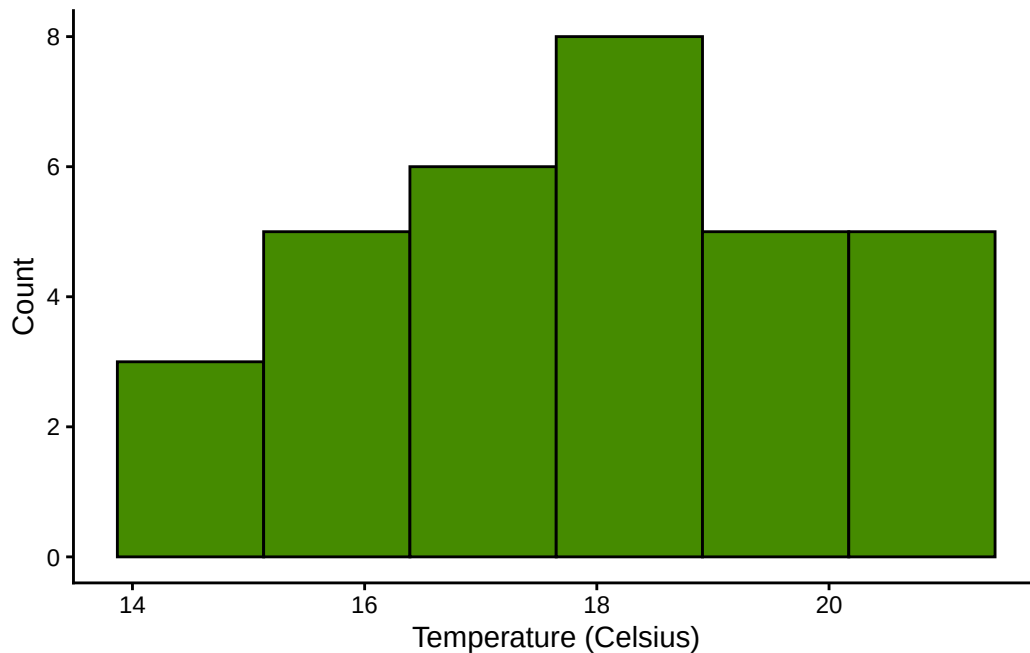
Since the data appears linear, we will run a Pearson's correlation, which requires checking for linearity (can be seen in the plot for 1b, it appears reasonably linear). We must also check for

continuous variables (which can be confirmed by thinking about the data, temperature and elongation rate are both continuous). Finally, we must check that the variables are normally distributed, which can be done by creating a histogram for each variable.

Histograms

Temperature

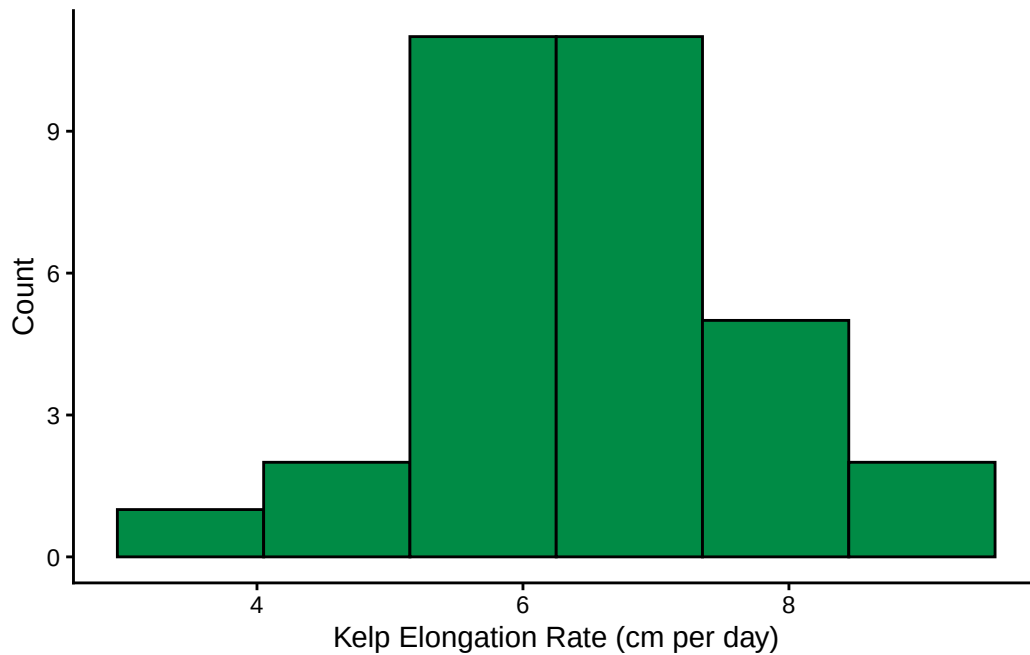
```
# create a histogram for the temperature
# use the kelp data and use the temperature column
ggplot(
  data = kelp,
  aes(x = temp_c)) +
  # create histogram with custom color, Rice Rule says to use 6 bins
  geom_histogram(bins = 6,
                 color = "black",
                 fill = "chartreuse4") +
  # rename axes
  labs(
    x = "Temperature (Celsius)",
    y = "Count"
  ) +
  # change theme to remove gridlines
  theme_classic()
```



The shape of the temperature distribution appears roughly normal (there's a slight skew, but not enough to be concerned about), so the normality assumption for this variable is met. We now must check for the elongation rate.

Elongation Rate

```
# create a histogram for the elongation rate
# use the kelp data and use the elongatiob rate column
ggplot(
  data = kelp,
  aes(x = kelp_elong)) +
  # create histogram with custom color, Rice Rule says to use 6 bins
  geom_histogram(bins = 6,
                 color = "black",
                 fill = "springgreen4") +
  # rename axes
  labs(
    x = "Kelp Elongation Rate (cm per day)",
    y = "Count"
  ) +
  # change theme to remove gridlines
  theme_classic()
```



Once again, the data for the elongation rate appears normally distributed, so assumptions for Pearson's correlation are met.

Correlation Test

```
# run pearson's correlation test
cor.test(kelp$temp_c, kelp$kelp_elong,
         method = "pearson")
```

Pearson's product-moment correlation

```
data: kelp$temp_c and kelp$kelp_elong
t = -5.189, df = 30, p-value = 1.366e-05
alternative hypothesis: true correlation is not equal to 0
95 percent confidence interval:
 -0.8359665 -0.4460157
sample estimates:
      cor
-0.6877489
```

To prepare for writing about the results, here are the important outputs.

$t = -5.189$

$df = 30$

$p < 0.001$

95% CI: [-0.836, -0.446]

$r = -0.688$

d.

To evaluate the strength of the relationship between water temperature (in Celsius) and kelp elongation rate (in cm per day), we used Pearson's correlation. We chose this because the scatterplot of data showing this relationship appeared linear, and the residuals were normally distributed and showed homoscedasticity.

We found a moderate, inverse relationship between water temperature and kelp elongation rate (Pearson's $r = -0.688$, $t(30) = -5.189$, $p < 0.001$, $\alpha = 0.05$).

e.

As ocean temperatures warm due to climate change, kelp growth rate is predicted to decrease. This will likely threaten the health of kelp and kelp forest ecosystems, reducing their ability regrow from disturbances like urchin grazing and slowing down the restoration of degraded kelp forests. This makes measures to protect existing kelp forests vitally important.

f.

The other test that could have been run was a Spearman's correlation, the non parametric variant of Pearson's correlation. The relationship appears monotonic (the data consistently trends downward), so the assumptions for this test were met too.

```
# run spearman's correlation test
# without the exact = false, the test returns an error since some data is of
# equal value and thus the same rank
cor.test(kelp$temp_c, kelp$kelp_elong,
         method = "spearman",
         exact = FALSE)
```

Spearman's rank correlation rho

```
data: kelp$temp_c and kelp$kelp_elong
S = 9216.1, p-value = 1.29e-05
alternative hypothesis: true rho is not equal to 0
sample estimates:
      rho
-0.6891684
```

After accounting for ties, the test returns a similar p-value ($p < 0.001$) and correlation ($\rho = -0.689$) to Pearson's correlation ($p < 0.001$, $r = -0.688$). Since the correlations differ by 0.001, we can conclude the same thing from both tests.

We found a moderate, inverse relationship between water temperature (in Celsius) and kelp elongation rate (in cm per day) (Spearman's $\rho = -0.689$, $S = 9216.1$, $p < 0.001$, $\alpha = 0.05$). Our model predicts that as water temperature increases, kelp will grow more slowly.

Note: Aside from the test results, this interpretation is equivalent to Pearson's correlation, which makes sense given the similar Pearson's r and Spearman's ρ .

Problem 2

a.

```
# create a new object to clean data
walk_clean <- walk |>
  # remove uppercases and add underscores
  clean_names() |>
  # remove N/A values
  drop_na()
# create a jitterplot for the data using walk_clean
ggplot(walk_clean,
  # x-axis: lunch location
  # y-axis: distance walked (in km)
  # color: set color by lunch location
  mapping = aes(x = lunch_location,
                 y = distance_walked_km,
                 color = lunch_location)) +
  # I want my y-axis to start at 0 so that scaling is visually accurate
  # Code from a geeksforgeeks forum
```

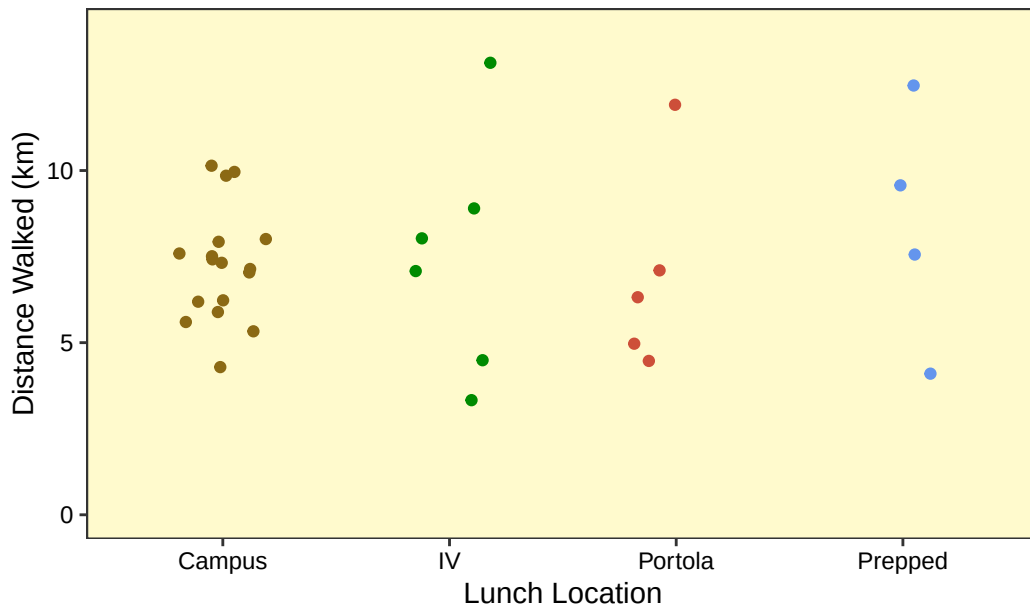


```

scale_y_continuous(limits=c(0, 14)) +
# Create a jitterplot
geom_jitter(
  # stop vertical jitter
  height = 0,
  # narrow horizontal jitter
  width = 0.2) +
# setting theme to black-white
theme_bw() +
# removing legend
theme(legend.position = "None") +
# renaming axes and title
labs(
  # renaming x-axis
  x = "Lunch Location",
  # renaming y-axis
  y = "Distance Walked (km)",
  # including subtitle for including last observation
  subtitle = "Last Observation: 2026, May 24th"
) +
# changing colors of various elements to improve contrast
theme(
  # change x-axis color
  axis.text.x = element_text(color = "black"),
  # change y-axis color
  axis.text.y = element_text(color = "black"),
  # change panel background
  panel.background = element_rect(fill = "lemonchiffon"),
  # change panel lines to blend in with background
  panel.grid = element_line(color = "lemonchiffon")
) +
# change colors of data points
scale_colour_manual(values = c(
  # change campus to a gold color to match UCSB :)
  "Campus" = "goldenrod4",
  # change IV to a lovely green
  "IV" = "green4",
  # change Portola to red
  "Portola" = "tomato3",
  # change prepped to a blue color
  "Prepped" = "cornflowerblue"
))

```

Last Observation: 2026, May 24th

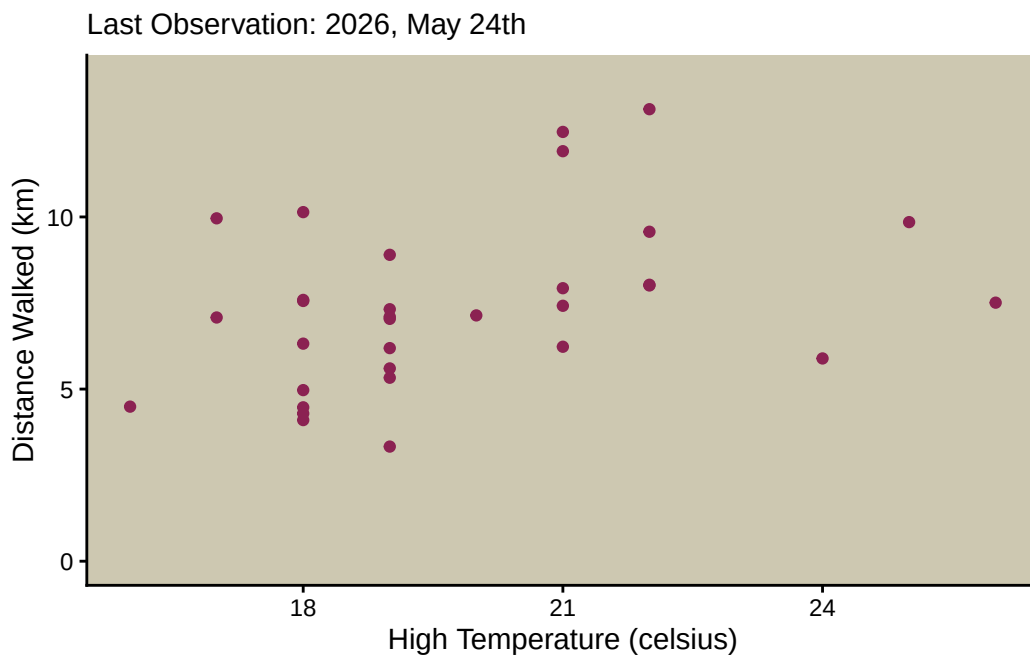


```
# create a scatterplot for the data using walk_clean
ggplot(walk_clean,
  # x-axis: high temperature (in celsius)
  # y-axis: distance walked (in km)
  # color: set color by lunch location
  mapping = aes(x = high_temperature_c,
    y = distance_walked_km)) +
# once again starting y from 0
# It would not make sense to set temperature to 0 too
# (this would make it hard to visualize the data's spread),
# so I am leaving the x-axis as is
scale_y_continuous(limits=c(0, 14)) +
# create a scatterplot with pink points
geom_point(color = "violetred4") +
# setting theme to classic
theme_classic() +
# removing legend
theme(legend.position = "None") +
# renaming axes and title
labs(
  # renaming x-axis
  x = "High Temperature (celsius)",
  # renaming y-axis
```

```

y = "Distance Walked (km)",
# creating subtitle with last observation
subtitle = "Last Observation: 2026, May 24th"
) +
# changing colors of various elements to improve contrast
theme(
# change x-axis color
axis.text.x = element_text(color = "black"),
# change y-axis color
axis.text.y = element_text(color = "black"),
# change panel background
panel.background = element_rect(fill = "cornsilk3"),
# change panel line colors to remove them
panel.grid = element_line(color = "cornsilk3"))

```



b.

Plot 1

Figure 1 - Distance Walked by Lunch Location

Each point's vertical position in the jitterplot represents the distance I walked, in kilometers, in one day. The colors and horizontal position represent where I had lunch that day, with each color corresponding to one of four lunch locations. **Campus** means that I purchased lunch on the main UCSB campus. **IV** means I purchased lunch in Isla Vista or had lunch at my home in Isla Vista. **Portola** means I had lunch at Portola Dining Commons. **Prepped** means I made food at home and ate it elsewhere. Data collected from my own observations using the app **Map My Walk**.

Plot 2

Figure 2 - Distance Walked by High Temperature

Each point's vertical position in the represents the distance I walked, in kilometers, in one day. The horizontal position represents the high temperature, in Celsius, for that day as predicted by the **Weather Underground** app when I woke up that morning. High temperature data is rounded to the nearest degree. Data collected from my own observations using the apps **Map My Walk** and **Weather Underground**.

Problem 3

a.

My personal data is about walking, but I don't want to take a fitness approach to it. Rather, I see walking as a way to slow down and view transit as a way to appreciate the world around you, so I want my visualization to reflect that in some way. Still, I can only appreciate the walk when I'm not stressed, which calendar events is a good proxy for. I also never used temperature in any of my infographic visualizations, and it's the only variable I didn't use, so I want to reflect that here in some way. Since I can represent many variables at once here (and Dear Data did that), I'll throw bus trips into the mix too.

I love the Dear Data visualizations, as it remains organized and readable while maintaining abstraction, it's a good way to get people curious about the data, and there is a lot of flexibility in how to show the data. I'm a plant person, and they're usually what I pay attention to during walks, so the plants (tomatoes specifically) are sneaking their way into this.

I will have number of fruits distance walked (rounded to the nearest kilometer). Roots ultimately support the plant, and when I'm stressed (more events), that should correspond to fewer roots. Temperature can be represented with leaf color (gradient, hot = leaves are burnt yellow). Bus trips can be represented by the number of flowers (the idea being that I often take the bus to go on a nice walk at the destination).

b.

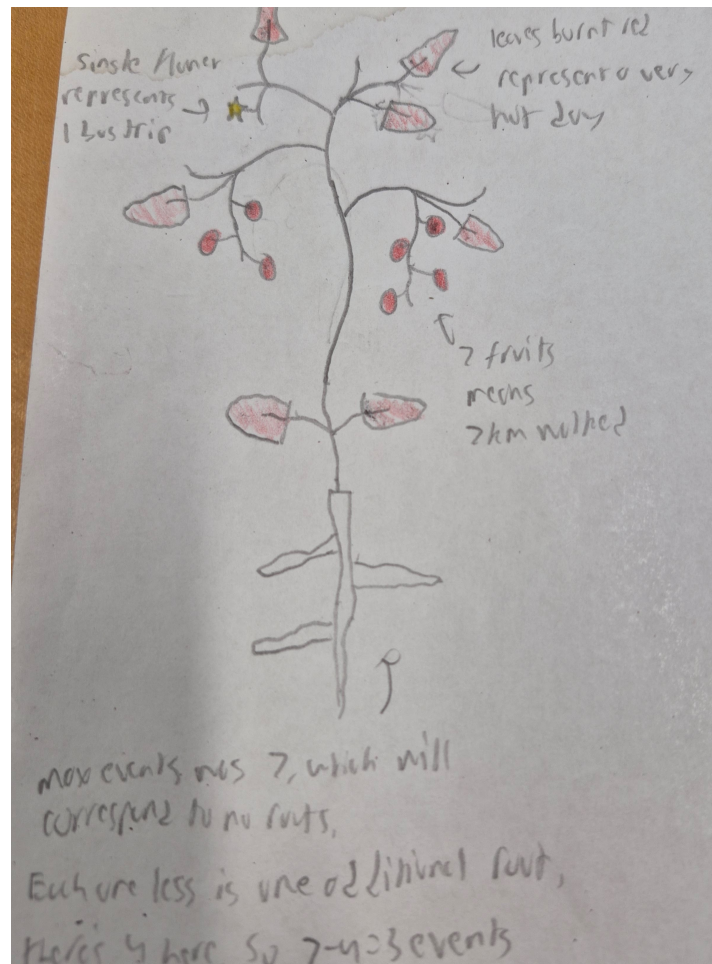


Figure 1: Affective Visualization Sketch

c.

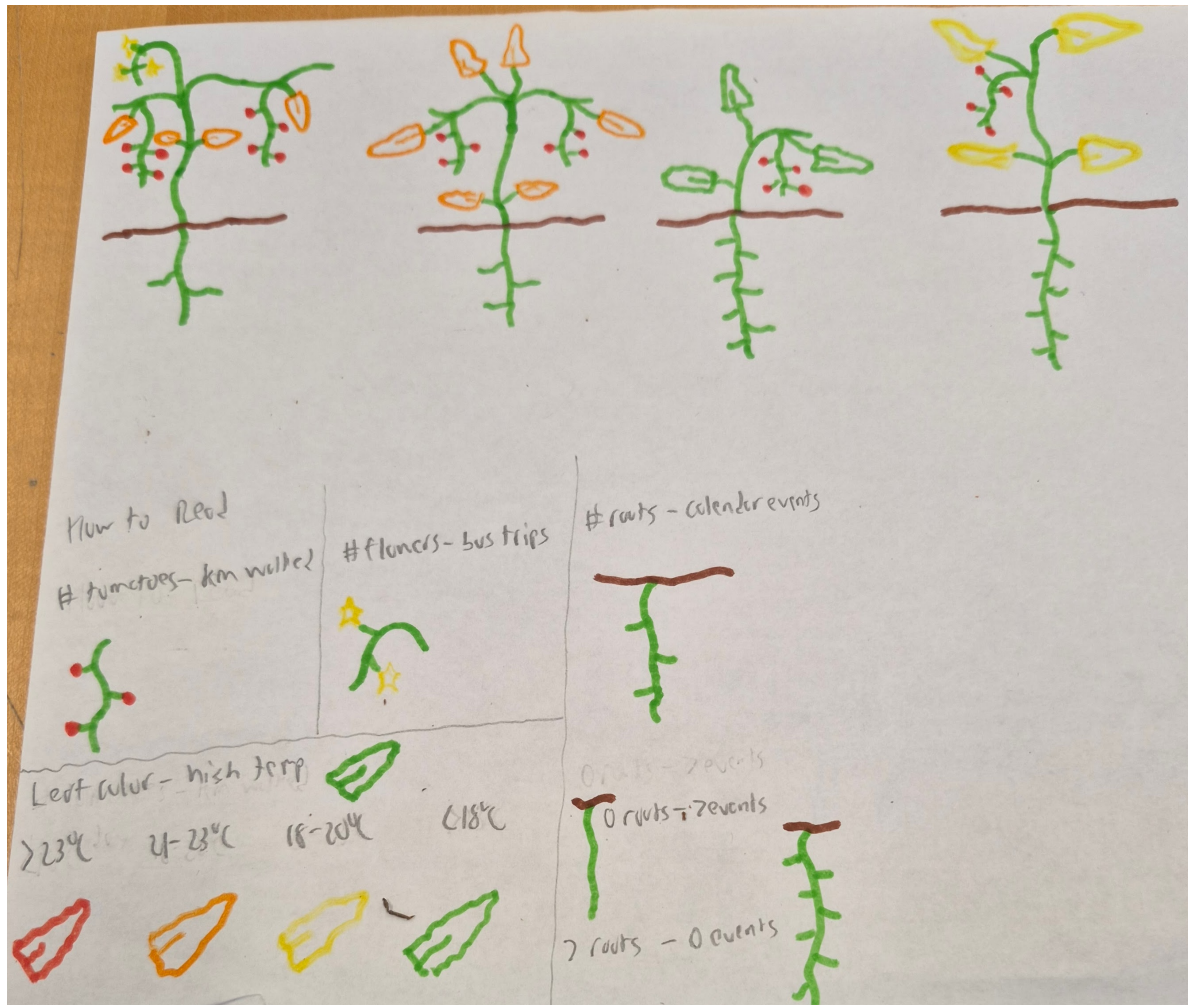


Figure 2: Affective Visualization Draft

d.

I took inspiration from the simplicity of the Dear Data visualizations and decided to make an abstract, hand drawn representation of my distance walked, bus trips, calendar events and high temperature of each day as a bunch of tomato plants (my favorite plant). I feel as though college is hectic but also unique, so I drew each plant in a similar manner. Just as Dear Data did, there is a key for interpreting the data in the drawings.

e.

The link to my Google Slides can be found [here](#)

Problem 4

a.

The test being used is a Wilcoxon test. The response variable is the abundance of nitrogen, phosphorus and potassium in the soil while the predictor variable is the application of vermicompost compared to the control. This test is used to see if vermicompost does actually increase soil nutrients. A statistically significant result would indicate that vermicomposting increases soil nitrogen, phosphorus and potassium.

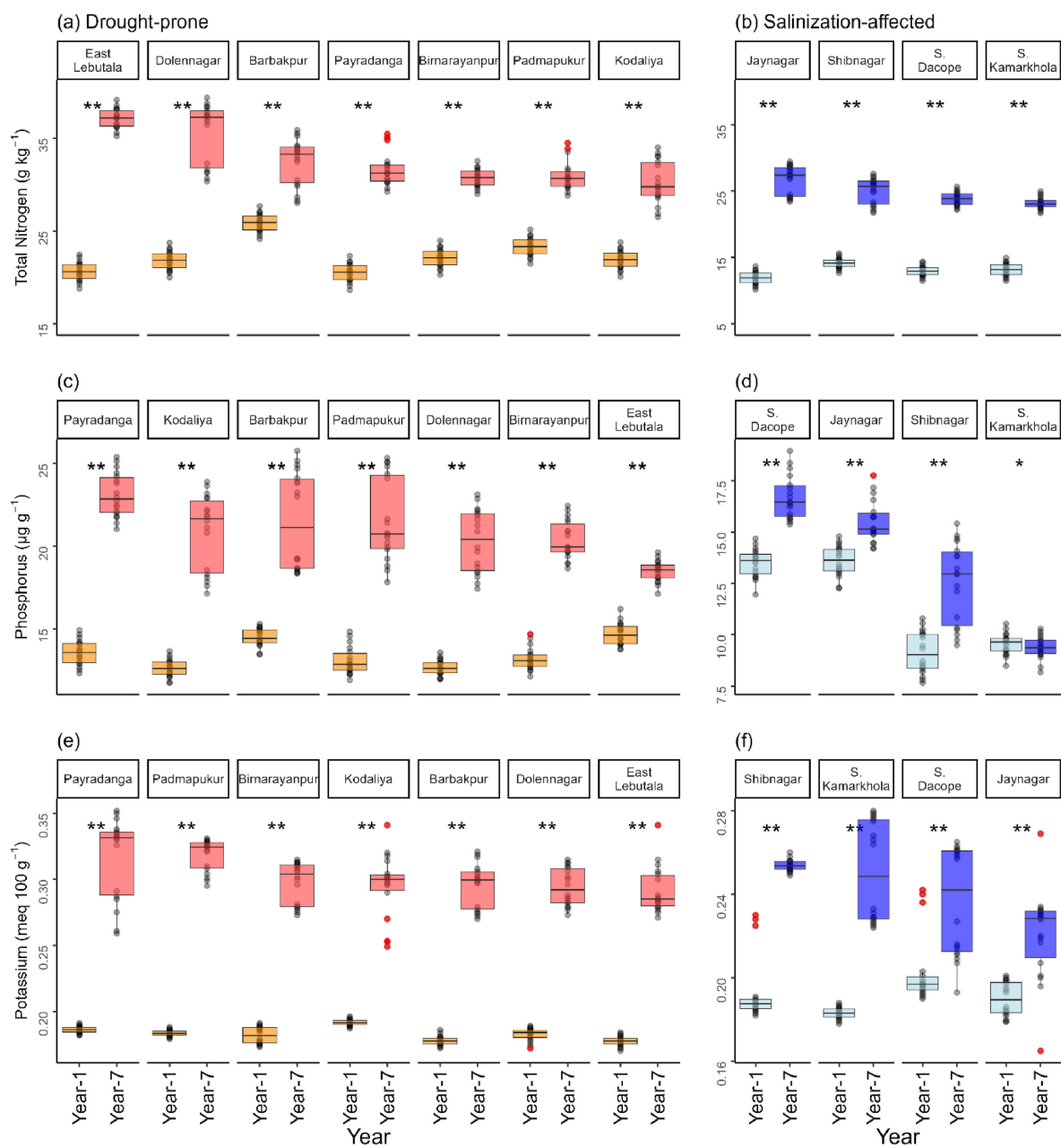


Figure 3: Vermicompost

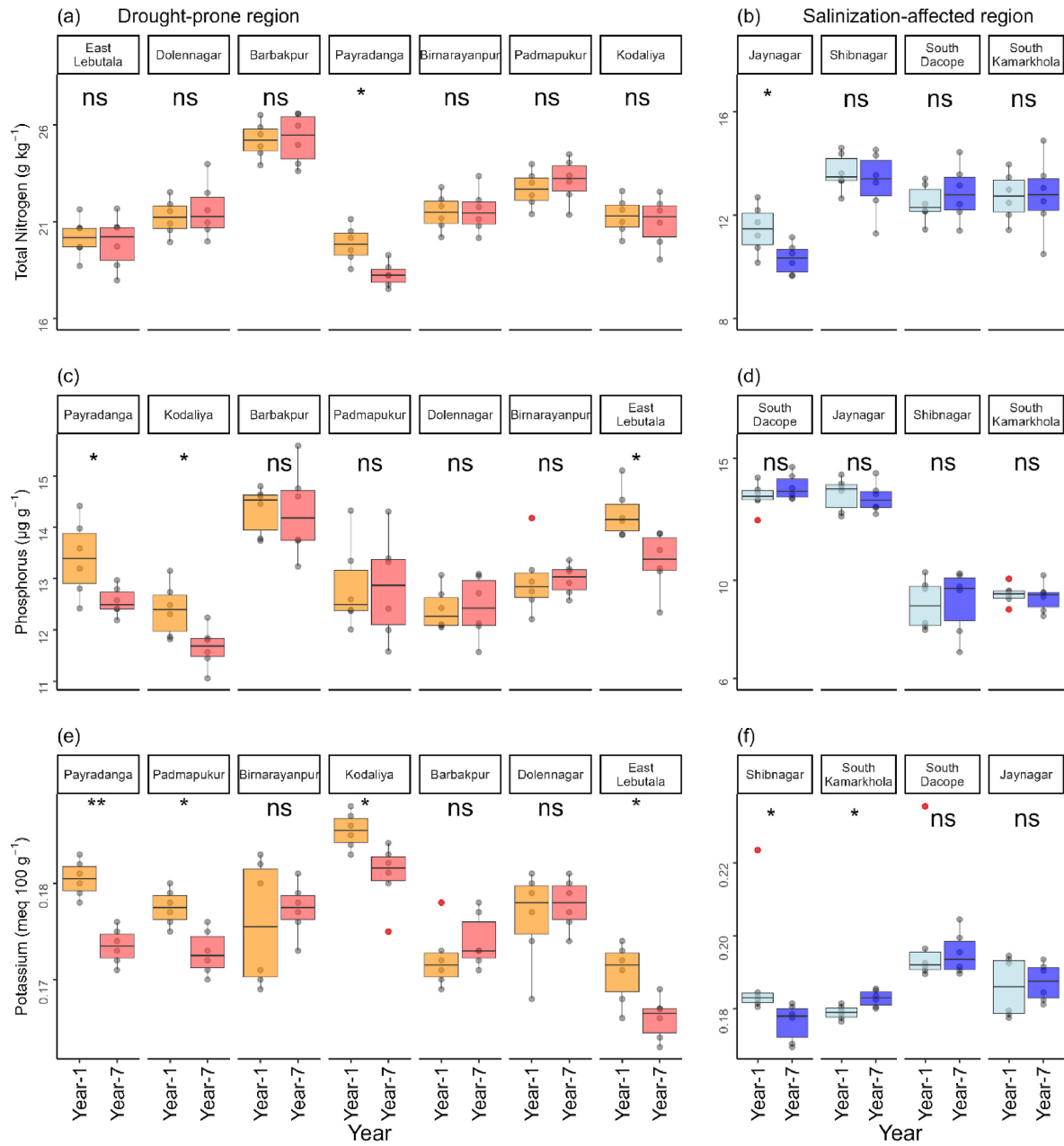


Figure 4: Control

b.

There is high visual clarity in the authors' figures. The boxplots establish metrics of central tendency and spread, and the underlying data is shown, though it doesn't distract from the

boxplots. The axes are clear, and from the axes labels, it's easy to see that these are comparing soil characteristics at different locations over time. The colors are effective, making it easy to differentiate years and see outliers. My main critique is that the y-axis in the left column is not necessarily aligned with the y-axis in the right column (ex: chart c ranges from 15-25 while chart d to the right ranges from 7.5-17.5 despite no new label and being horizontally level with figure c).

c.

The figure does a good job reducing visual clutter. The only elements are present are those that are essential to making the chart readable (for example, locations and axis labels). Listing year 1 and year 7 for every location does increase ink relative to data, and it could potentially be improved by using year as a major axis label and just listing the number for each location, but this could also make the chart less intuitive, so I understand the authors' choice. The overall data:ink ratio is fairly high; there is a lot of data described with little text.

d.

The figures are mostly good as is, but I would realign figures b, d and f (right column) so that their y-axes aligned with figures a, c and e, as this would allow for better comparison between the drought-prone and salinization-affected regions. Listing year twice on the x-axis is also redundant, so I would remove the smaller year label and just keep the number.